Paper LI

The S8 Tension Resolution:

Gravitational Slip η(z) from Paper L Suppresses Weak Lensing

and Predicts S8 = 0.787 with Zero Free Parameters

Σ(z) = (1+η(z))/2 · S8_MSDS = 0.7871 · S8_obs = 0.7849 · Tension: 2.9σ → 0.1σ

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Companion to Papers I–L | arXiv/Zenodo

ABSTRACT

The S8 tension — the 2.9-sigma discrepancy between the Planck CMB prediction S8 = 0.831 and the KiDS-1000 weak lensing measurement S8 = 0.785 — has no solution within standard LCDM. This paper shows that the MSDS gravitational slip eta(z) derived in Paper L naturally resolves it through a mechanism called lensing suppression, requiring zero new parameters. In MSDS, the dilaton coupling to matter is extremely weak (Paper XLIX), so the matter growth rate is approximately GR. However, photon geodesics feel the lensing potential (Phi+Psi)/2 = Psi(1+eta)/2, which is suppressed by the factor Sigma(z) = (1+eta(z))/2 < 1. Weak lensing surveys infer sigma8 from the lensing signal — not from the matter directly. When Sigma < 1, the inferred sigma8 is lower than the true value. Using eta(z) from Paper L with Delta_0 = 0.042 and s = 3/4, the effective lensing suppression factor over the KiDS-1000 source distribution (z ~ 0.1–0.9) is Sigma_eff = 0.9472. This predicts sigma8_WL = 0.7682, S8_MSDS = 0.7871, compared to the KiDS-1000 measurement of S8 = 0.7849. The tension falls from 2.9sigma (GR) to 0.1sigma (MSDS). The prediction contains no free parameters — Delta_0 was derived from energy minimization in Paper XLVII, and s = 3/4 from WKB evolution in Paper L. This is not a model fit: it is the direct prediction of 50 papers of MSDS theory, applied to the most contested number in observational cosmology.

I. The S8 Tension and Its Physical Origin

The S8 tension is the most statistically significant discrepancy in modern cosmology. It arises because two methods of measuring the same quantity disagree:

- **CMB (Planck 2020):** Fits the primordial power spectrum to ΛCDM and predicts σ8 = 0.811, giving S8 = 0.8310. This measurement is at z~1100 and propagated forward using GR.
- **Weak gravitational lensing (KiDS-1000, DES):** Directly measures the lensing convergence power spectrum at z~0.3–0.9, inferring S8 = 0.7849 ± 0.016.

The discrepancy is 2.9σ — significant enough to exclude statistical fluctuation, yet resistant to systematic error explanations. The MSDS framework offers a physical resolution.

II. The Mechanism: Lensing Suppression from η(z)

The key insight requires two results from previous papers:

- **Paper XLIX:** The dilaton-matter coupling is extremely weak. The Goldberger-Treiman analog gives a clock coupling of ~89σ (ruled out), while the gravitational coupling gives ~10■■■σ (undetectable). The physical coupling lies somewhere between, but is small enough that μ ≈ 1: the effective Newton's constant for matter perturbations is approximately GR.
- **Paper L:** The gravitational slip η(z) = (1 - Δ■(1+z)^s)/(1 + Δ■(1+z)^s) with Δ■ = 0.042 and s = 3/4. This gives η(z=0.5) = 0.8923.

These two facts together imply:

Matter perturbations: -k^2 Psi = 4pi G a^2 rho delta [mu approx 1, GR growth]

(Newtonian gauge — matter feels Ψ, which is sourced normally)

Photon geodesics: lensing potential = (Phi + Psi)/2 = Psi (1+eta)/2

(photons feel BOTH potentials — the slip suppresses the lensing signal)

The effective lensing suppression factor:

Sigma(z) = (1 + eta(z)) / 2

(lensing efficiency relative to GR — Sigma < 1 when eta < 1)

z	η(z)	Σ(z) = (1+η)/2	Lensing vs GR
0.0	0.9194	0.95969	-4.03%
0.2	0.9081	0.95406	-4.59%
0.5	0.8923	0.94614	-5.39%
0.7	0.8823	0.94115	-5.88%
1.0	0.8680	0.93402	-6.60%
1.5	0.8459	0.92293	-7.71%
2.0	0.8253	0.91263	-8.74%

Table 1: Lensing suppression Σ(z) from MSDS η(z). At z=0.5: lensing is suppressed by 5.4% relative to GR.

III. The S8 Prediction

Weak lensing surveys infer σ8 from the convergence power spectrum, which is a weighted integral of the lensing signal over the source distribution:

C_kk(l) ∝ ∫ q(z)^2 × Sigma(z)^2 × P_matter(k,z) dz

(lensing convergence power — suppressed by Σ(z)² relative to GR)

The effective lensing-weighted Σ over the KiDS-1000 source distribution:

$$\text{Sigma_eff}^2 = \int q(z)^2 \times \text{Sigma}(z)^2\, dz \,/\, \int q(z)^2\, dz \quad [z \sim 0.1 \text{ to } 0.9]$$

Sigma_eff = 0.94719 (compared to GR: Sigma_eff = 1.000)

The predicted weak-lensing inferred σ8:

$$\text{sigma8_WL_MSDS} = \text{sigma8_CMB} \times \text{Sigma_eff} = 0.811 \times 0.94719$$

= 0.7682 (compared to GR prediction: 0.8110)

THE PRIMARY RESULT OF PAPER LI:

S8_MSDS = sigma8_WL_MSDS × (Omega_m/0.3)^0.5 = 0.7871

S8_KiDS-1000 (observed) = 0.7849 ± 0.016

S8_Planck (GR prediction) = 0.8310

Tension: GR vs KiDS = 2.9σ → MSDS vs KiDS = 0.1σ

The S8 tension is resolved at 0.1σ level.

Zero new parameters: Δ■ from Paper XLVII, s=3/4 from Paper L.

IV. Why This Is Not a Coincidence

The resolution is parameter-free in a strong sense:

- **Δ■ = 0.042** was derived in Paper XLVII from the energy minimization of the Schwarz P vacuum functional at ξ = 2. It was not chosen to match S8. It was derived from the Lagrangian.
- **s = 3/4** was derived in Paper L from the WKB evolution of an oscillating scalar field in ΛCDM. It was not chosen to optimise any fit.
- **The η(z) formula** is a direct consequence of these two numbers and the Paper XLVII potential structure. It is not adjustable.
- **The mechanism** (lensing suppression, not growth suppression) follows from the weak dilaton coupling derived in Paper XLIX. A strong coupling would give a completely different prediction.

Every ingredient was derived independently before this paper existed. The S8 resolution is a consequence, not a design.

V. Kill Conditions and Falsifiability

Test	MSDS prediction	Kill condition	Instrument
S8 from WL	S8 = 0.7871	S8 > 0.810 (GR level)	KiDS / DES

Σ(z) from WL+CMB	Σ_eff = 0.9472	Σ_eff consistent with 1	Euclid WL
fσ8 from RSD	fσ8 ≈ GR (μ ≈ 1)	fσ8 << GR	DESI/LSST
Joint CMB+WL+RSD	η < 1, μ ≈ 1	μ significantly ≠ 1	Euclid DR1

Table 2: Kill conditions for the MSDS S8 resolution.

Figure 1: The S8 tension resolution. Top row (wide): η(z) from Paper L (green) and the derived lensing factor Σ(z)=(1+η)/2 (orange dashed). The blue shaded region shows the KiDS-1000 lensing kernel — the lensing survey is sensitive to z~0.3–0.9 where Σ ≈ 0.945–0.960. The lensing deficit (orange shading) represents the suppressed signal that weak lensing infers as lower σ8. Top-right: numerical summary. Bottom-left: the S8 comparison chart — MSDS (green, S8=0.7871) bridges GR (red, 0.8310) and KiDS (orange, 0.7849). Bottom-centre: S8_MSDS vs Δ■ — the Paper XLVII value of 0.042 naturally falls near the observed S8, demonstrating this is not a tuned fit. Bottom-right: the physical chain from Papers XLVII → L → XLIX → LI.

The universe was telling us η ≠ 1 through weak lensing all along. We called it a tension. Paper L gave us η(z). Paper LI shows it was always a prediction.

References

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